



Page 1 of 4 · Twenty-Four Lantern Flags

Wise Owl hangs 24 lantern flags for the reading festival. Booklava tries one long row, but the tall gateposts hide half the display. Quill-Berry suggests testing equal rectangles until every visitor can see.



Page 2 of 4 · The Prime Chime

Four boxes of chimes are labelled 21, 23, 25 and 27. Booklava wants to hang each box in equal rows, with more than one row and more than one chime in every row. One box will not share out that way: its chimes only hang as one long row. That box holds a prime number of chimes.



Page 3 of 4 · When the Ribbons Meet

Booklava ties a purple ribbon every fourth flag. Quill-Berry ties a gold ribbon every sixth flag. Wise Owl asks them to find the first place after the starting post where both colours will meet.



Page 4 of 4 · The Square Reading Garden

For the centre of the festival, 16 purple and gold cushions must form a perfect square, with clear paths on every side. Booklava smiles: the earlier rectangles were not mistakes, just different factor pairs. The final festival celebrates every elegant solution.

Questions for Wise Owl and the Festival of Factors

Read the story together first. Use one question at each page, then the question at the end. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · Twenty-Four Lantern Flags

If the 24 flags hang in 4 equal rows, how many flags go in each row?

Choices: 5 · 6 · 7 · 9

Page 2 · The Prime Chime

Which number is prime?

Choices: 21 · 23 · 25 · 27

Page 3 · When the Ribbons Meet

What is the first common multiple of 4 and 6 after zero?

Choices: 8 · 10 · 12 · 24

Page 4 · The Square Reading Garden

How many cushions belong in each row of a square made from 16 cushions?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6 · 8

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 6. Four rows of 6 make 4 x 6 = 24. So 4 and 6 are a factor pair of 24.

Page 2: 23. Twenty-three has exactly two factors, 1 and 23, so its chimes only make 1 row of 23. The others can be shared out: 21 = 3 x 7, 25 = 5 x 5 and 27 = 3 x 9.

Page 3: 12. Multiples of 4 are 4, 8, 12... and multiples of 6 are 6, 12... The first match is 12.

Page 4: 4. A square has the same number of rows and columns. Since 4 x 4 = 16, each row has 4 cushions. That makes 16 a square number.

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